

The Bootean Frontier: An Introductory History

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Overview: The Great Disappearing

Over the last century, a steady trickle of homesteaders, pioneers, and political dissidents began a clandestine exodus from the Terran Federation. Driven by a desire for radical autonomy and a rejection of even the "loose" oversight of the Terran government, these groups vanished into the Rimward sectors. Historically dismissed as "weirdos on the fringe" in official registries, these individuals have quietly forged a civilization known as the Bootean Federation. Located roughly Jump-3 beyond the recognized borders of the Terran Federation, the Bootean systems were once considered unreachable for standard civilian vessels. Their survival and eventual expansion were made possible only through a controversial partnership with the megacorporation **Hephaestos**.

I. Astrography and Scale

The Bootean Federation is primarily concentrated within the rimward section of the **Capella Subsector**. Their influence extends slightly into the neighboring **Gemini Subsector**, though they occupy only a tiny fraction of that region—specifically five systems. In total, the Federation encompasses approximately **20 systems**, a stark contrast to the vast expanse of the Terran Federation.

Subsector	Status	Notes
Capella (Rimward)	Primary Territory	Heart of the Bootean movement.
Gemini	Minor Presence	Occupying 5 systems only.

II. Systems of Interest

- **Sequoyah:** The political nexus. While governance is minimal, this is the site of the

irregular diplomatic summits and the registry for expansion data.

- **Cameroon:** The corporate hub. Cameroon serves as the primary record-keeping and administrative center for the **Hephaestos Corporation**, functioning as the backbone of their local logistics.
- **Labrys:** An anomaly in Bootean policy. Labrys is the only system currently **interdicted** by a combined Bootean peacekeeping force. It is inhabited by the **Labrysians**, a native TL-7 species with no interest in space flight. The interdiction is a rare instance of the Federation acting collectively to prevent unregulated exploitation.

III. The Hephaestos Pact

Lacking the industrial base to manufacture their own interstellar technology, the early Bootean settlers entered into a symbiotic—and some say exploitative—deal with Hephaestos. The corporation provided the outfitting, Jump-1 technology, and initial transport required to cross the void. In exchange, Bootean planets allow Hephaestos near-total autonomy to establish operations within their systems.

The result is a landscape where corporate enclaves of TL 12+ sophistication exist alongside settler towns struggling at TL 9. Hephaestos provides the "keys" to the stars, while the Booteans provide the territory and a market free from Terran regulatory interference. This relationship has led some Terran observers to describe the region as an "Age of Sail Pirate Republic sponsored by the East India Company."

IV. Governance: The Compact of Sequoyah

The Bootean "Federation" is a misnomer by Terran standards. It is not a state, but a defensive alliance and a non-aggression pact. The central government is essentially non-existent, manifesting only during irregular, unscheduled diplomatic summits on the planet **Sequoyah**—currently the most powerful and influential system in the region.

Member systems agree to only two fundamental principles:

- **Collective Defense:** To come to each other's aid if attacked by an outside power (most notably the Terran Federation, which they fear).
- **Free Transit:** Official forces of any member state may not harass or attack vessels traveling through Bootean space.

Unlike the Terran Federation, there is no central military to enforce these rules. Order is maintained through the threat of mutual retaliation and the shared philosophy of non-interference.

V. The Fuel-Standard Economy

Economic stability in a region without a central bank is maintained through the **Bootean Dollar (B\$)**. The B\$ is a stable currency that all members convert their local currencies into at flexible exchange rates. Uniquely, the B\$ is pegged to the cost of **refined fuel**, ensuring its utility for

any star-faring entity.

Metric	Bootean Federation (B\$)	Terran Federation (Cr)
Standard Value	1 B\$ $\approx$ 1 Unit Refined Fuel (Approx.)	1 Credit (Standardized)
Exchange Rate	Flexible / Market Driven	Fixed / Regulated
Backing	Commodity-Pegged (Fuel)	Federal Reserves

Currently, 1 Bootean Dollar is roughly equivalent to 1 Terran Federation Credit.

VI. The "No Questions Asked" Expansion

Expansion is the lifeblood of the Bootean frontier. Since population growth is entirely organic (cloning is rejected for initial settlement), the Federation encourages spread through a radical subsidy program:

- **Financial Incentive:** Explorers are paid the total cost of their expedition expenses plus a 100,000 B\$ bonus.
- **The "No Questions Asked" Policy:** There are no contracts, no reporting requirements, and no legal responsibilities once data is transferred to the Federation at Sequoyah.

VII. Social Fabric: Liberty Without Limits

The Bootean Federation represents the absolute limit of the "frontier spirit." Without the "guard rails" of the Terran Federation, individual liberty often descends into anarchy or local tyranny. Law enforcement activity is low, and organized crime is rampant. Because the Federation sets no moral or legal limits on its members, some systems engage in practices that would be criminal in the Terran Federation, including mass slavery or genocide, with no official oversight or condemnation.

It is a place of extreme danger, radical freedom, and untapped potential—where the only law that truly matters is the strength of one's own crew and the reliability of their Jump-1 drive.

VIII. Foreign Relations: The Tarsus Tension

While the Booteans fear the eventual "rediscovery" by the Terran Federation, their most immediate neighborly friction is with the **Tarsus System**. Tarsus is the known refuge of the **Ursa**—uplifted bears who fled Terran space centuries ago. Relations between the Bootean pioneers and the reclusive Ursa are notoriously poor, often defined by border disputes and a mutual distrust of each other's territorial ambitions.